

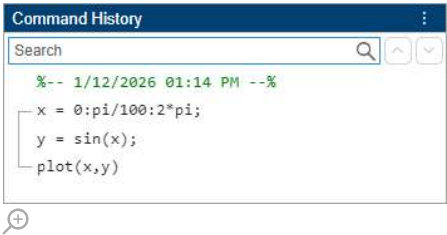
Command History

View previously run statements

Description

The Command History displays a log of statements that you ran in the current and previous MATLAB® sessions. The Command History lists the date and time of each session in the short date format for your operating system, followed by the statements from that session. Brackets in the left margin indicate statements that were processed as a group. A red mark precedes each group of statements that generated an error.

You can select entries in the Command History and then perform these actions for the selected entries.



Action	How to Perform the Action
Create a script from statements.	Select an entry or entries, and then right-click and select Create Script or Create Live Script from the context menu. The Editor or Live Editor opens a new file that contains the statements you selected from the Command History.
Rerun previous statements.	Do one of the following: • Press the up arrow key (↑) until the statement you want appears at the prompt, and then press Enter. • Double-click an entry in the Command History. • Select an entry or entries in the Command History and press Enter. To extend the selection to include multiple statements, press Shift+↑.
Copy statements to another window.	Select an entry or entries, and then do one of the following: • Right-click and select Copy from the context menu. Paste the selection into an open file in the Editor or any application. • From the Command History panel, drag the selection to an open file or another application.
Create a favorite command from statements.	Select an entry or entries, and then right-click and select Create New Favorite . The Favorite Commands Editor opens with the selected entries added to the Code field. Configure the other fields and click Save .

Action	How to Perform the Action
	For more information about favorite commands, see Create and Run Favorite Commands .
Delete entries.	Select the entries to delete, and then right-click and select Delete, or press the Delete key. To delete all entries, click the actions button  and select Clear Command History from the context menu. You cannot recall entries deleted in this way.

Open the Command History

You can view the Command History in a pop-up window off of the Command Window or docked in the Command History panel.

- **Pop-up window** – To view all the history, press the up arrow key ($\uparrow$) in the Command Window. To view a specific statement, type any part of the statement at the prompt and then press the up arrow key.
The Command History pop-up window closes after you act on a selected statement. You also can close the pop-up window by pressing the **Esc** key. To disable the pop-up window, go to the **Home** tab, and in the **Environment** section, click **Layout**. Then, in the **Layout Options** section, clear the **Command History > Popup** option.
- **Docked** – Click the Command History icon  on the sidebar. If the Command History icon is not on a sidebar, click the Open more panels button **...** and select **Command History**. You also can enter `commandhistory` in the Command Window.

To change how MATLAB searches for results in the Command History, click the actions button  in the Command History pop-up window or panel and select from the available options, including **Match Anywhere**, **Match Beginning**, and **Match Case**. For more information about additional settings, see [Modify Command History Settings](#).

Examples

[collapse all](#)

Find Previous Plot Statements

Use the Command History to find and run previous `plot` statements.

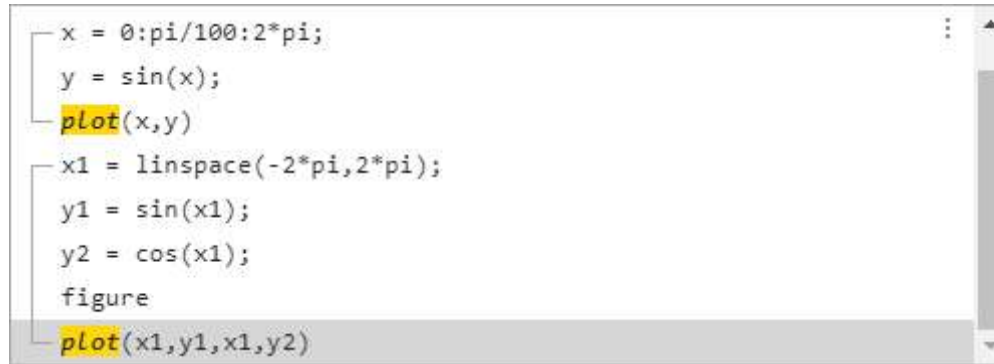
In the Command Window, run these statements to create two line plots.

```
x = 0:pi/100:2*pi;
y = sin(x);
plot(x,y)

x1 = linspace(-2*pi,2*pi);
y1 = sin(x1);
y2 = cos(x1);

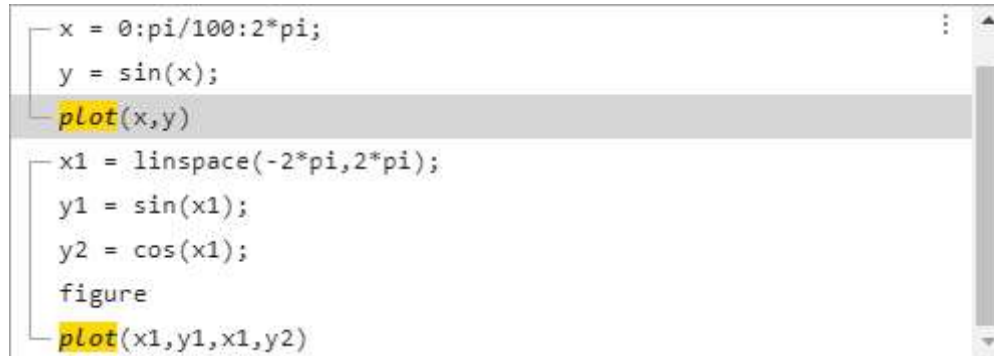
figure
plot(x1,y1,x1,y2)
```

Type `plot` and then press the up arrow key. MATLAB displays the Command History with all instances of `plot` highlighted. The last run instance of `plot` is selected.



```
x = 0:pi/100:2*pi;  
y = sin(x);  
plot(x,y)  
x1 = linspace(-2*pi,2*pi);  
y1 = sin(x1);  
y2 = cos(x1);  
figure  
plot(x1,y1,x1,y2)
```

Press the up arrow key to select the previous run instance of `plot` and press **Enter**. MATLAB runs the statement `plot(x,y)`.



```
x = 0:pi/100:2*pi;  
y = sin(x);  
plot(x,y)  
x1 = linspace(-2*pi,2*pi);  
y1 = sin(x1);  
y2 = cos(x1);  
figure  
plot(x1,y1,x1,y2)
```

Programmatic Use

`commandhistory` opens the Command History panel when it is closed, and selects the Command History panel when it is open.

More About

[collapse all](#)

Saved Command History

MATLAB saves the statements that run in the Command Window to the Command History. These statements include those you run using the **Evaluate Selection** item on context menus in tools such as the Editor, Live Editor, and Command History.

By default, MATLAB automatically saves statements to the Command History after they run. MATLAB does not save every action taken in MATLAB. For example, changes to plots in a figure window are not saved.

All statements remain in the Command History until you delete them or until the number of statements exceeds the number of statements to save, as specified in the Command History settings. When the specified limit is reached, MATLAB automatically deletes the oldest statements. By default, the Command History saves 25,000 statements.

Version History

[collapse all](#)

Introduced before R2006a

R2025a: Command History saved to settings instead of history file 

MATLAB now saves the Command History to settings. Previously, MATLAB saved the Command History to the history

file History.xml in the settings folder.

See Also

Functions

[diary](#)

Tools

[Command Window](#)

Topics

[Modify Command History Settings](#)

[Configure the Desktop](#)

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